



MODULE NAME:	MODULE CODE:
INFORMATION SYSTEMS 1A	INSY5111/w

ASSESSMENT TYPE: ASSIGNMENT 1 (PAPER ONLY)

TOTAL MARK ALLOCATION: 100 MARKS

TOTAL HOURS: 10 HOURS

By submitting this assignment, you acknowledge that you have read and understood all the rules as per the terms in the registration contract, in particular the assignment and assessment rules in The IIE Assessment Strategy and Policy (IIE009), the intellectual integrity and plagiarism rules in the Intellectual Integrity and Property Rights Policy (IIE023), as well as any rules and regulations published in the student portal.

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. ***No material may be copied from original sources, even if referenced correctly, unless it is a direct quote indicated with quotation marks. No more than 10% of the assignment may consist of direct quotes.***
2. ***Your assignment must be submitted through Turnitin.***
3. ***Save a copy of your assignment before submitting it.***
4. ***Assignments must be typed unless otherwise specified.***
5. ***All work must be adequately and correctly referenced.***
6. ***This is an individual assignment.***

Referencing Rubric

Providing evidence based on valid and referenced academic sources is a fundamental educational principle and the cornerstone of high-quality academic work. Part of achieving this quality is referencing in a way that is consistent and congruent with the requirements of the referencing style being used.

Therefore, inconsistent and/or incongruent referencing will result in a penalty of **a maximum of ten percent being deducted from the overall percentage** awarded to your assessment submission.

Please note that **evidence of plagiarism** in the form of copied or unreferenced work, absent reference lists, or exceptionally poor referencing **may result in action being taken in accordance with The IIE's Intellectual Integrity and Property Rights Policy (IIE023)**. Similarly, **evidence of excessive AI usage may result in action being taken in accordance with The IIE's Student Conduct, Discipline and Safety Policy (IIE015)**.

Markers are required to provide feedback to students by **circling/underlining the information in the table below that best describes the student's work and by adding constructive commentary where appropriate**. The examples provided are not exhaustive but illustrate the errors.

Deductions

- Where the student's work contains **five or more errors** aligned to the **minor errors column** below, **deduct 5% from the overall percentage**.
- Where the student's work contains **five or more errors** aligned to the **major errors column** below, **deduct 10% from the overall percentage**.
- Where both minor and major errors** (e.g. two minor and three major, etc.) are present, **deduct 10% only** (and not 5% or 15%) from the overall percentage.

Required: Consistent and congruent referencing	Minor errors Deduct 5% from overall percentage. Example: if the response receives 70%, deduct 5%. The final mark is 65%.	Major errors Deduct 10% from the overall percentage. Example: if the response receives 70%, deduct 10%. The final mark is 60%.
Consistency - The correct referencing style for the discipline – i.e., either Harvard, OR APA (for Psychology), OR Law, OR IEEE (for ICT/Engineering) – has been used consistently for all in-text references and in the bibliography/reference list. Concepts and ideas that are quoted and/or paraphrased are referenced consistently throughout. Position of the in-text reference: an in-text reference is positioned consistently where appropriate for every quote and paraphrase.	Minor inconsistencies: - The referencing style used is generally consistent with what is required, but there are one or two changes/errors in the format of in-text referencing and/or in the bibliography/reference list. - For example, page numbers for direct quotes in-text have been provided for one source, but not in another. Or, two book chapters in the bibliography/reference list have been referenced in two different formats. Or, the publication year has been placed after the author name in one bibliography/reference list entry, and after the source title in another, etc. - Concepts and ideas in quotes and/or paraphrases are typically referenced, but a full in-text reference is missing or incomplete from one or two small sections of the work. - Position of the references: in-text references are only given at the beginning and/or end of every paragraph.	Major inconsistencies: - Poor and wholly inconsistent referencing style used in-text and/or in the bibliography/reference list. - Multiple referencing styles for the same source types have been used. - For example, the format for direct quotes in-text and/or book chapters in the bibliography/reference list and/or year of publication in the bibliography/reference list is different across multiple instances. - Concepts and ideas in quotes and/or paraphrases are haphazardly referenced in-text. - Position of the references: in-text references are only given at the beginning or end of large sections of work.
Feedback on referencing consistency:		
Congruency Each source reflected within in-text references is included accurately in the bibliography/reference list. - All bibliography/reference list entries are in the required order for the referencing style used (e.g. alphabetical, alphabetical under subheadings, numerical). - All direct quotes and paraphrases have been integrated appropriately into the text using introductory phrases, accurate grammar, etc.	Minor incongruities: - There is largely a match between the sources presented in-text and those in the bibliography/reference list, but one or two sources that appear in-text do not appear in the bibliography/reference list, or vice versa. Or key source information is missing from one or two in-text references or bibliography/reference list entries only (e.g. publication year, city of publication, URL date accessed, etc.). - There is a clear and largely accurate ordering of sources in the bibliography/reference list as required by the referencing style used, but with one or two references out of order. - An attempt has been made for source integration into the text using appropriate introductory phrases and grammar, but one or two quotes or paraphrases do not flow as clearly or logically within the sentence structure as they could.	Major incongruities: - No relationship/several incongruities between the in-text referencing and the bibliography/reference list. - For example, multiple sources are included in-text, but not in the bibliography, and/or vice versa. Key source information is missing from multiple in-text references and/or reference list entries. A URL link, rather than the actual reference, is provided in the bibliography. Sources are repeated in the reference list, etc. - Most sources are listed in a haphazard order throughout the bibliography/reference list. - Few to no appropriate introductory phrases or rules of grammar have been applied, and many direct quotes and/or paraphrases feel disconnected from the flow of the text.
Feedback on referencing congruency:		
Overall feedback on referencing, with suggested improvements:		

Assignment Instructions

Type all relevant instructions for students that are specific to this assignment here.

These must include:

- *Any research requirements: prescribed text reading, recommended reading, or additional reading required.*
- *Writing requirements: an essay, a presentation, etc.*
- *Referencing requirements: the reference rubric will be used, the Harvard style must be used unless an alternative referencing style is prescribed in your discipline (e.g., APA referencing is to be used in the Psychology discipline), and the submission must be submitted through SafeAssign. Law students are to consult the IIE Law Style Guidelines and Legal Referencing document.*
- *Word count limitations: For word counts, each question must specify an equitable range (e.g., 800 – 1000 words), suitable both for the NQF level of the assignment and the question requirements. Always include the following disclaimer for word counts, adapted accordingly as needed:*

NB – *Your lecturer will not mark beyond the maximum word count for the question. For example, if you exceed the 1000-word limit by submitting a 1200-word essay, you could lose all marks allocated to any sections/arguments that fall into the 200 words not marked.*

Assignment Topic 1**(Marks: 40)**

Read the case study extract below and answer all the questions that follow.

Title: Checkers Hyper uses Information Systems to become South Africa's Leading Retailer

Checkers Hyper is the South African's largest retailer, earning billions of Rands on sales in the recent fiscal years. Checkers currently serves millions of South African customers every week. Checkers Hyper's rise to prominence is due in no small part to their use of information systems.

One of the keys to this success was the implementation of Retail Link, a supply-chain management system. This system, unique when initially implemented in the mid-1980s, allowed Checkers Hyper's suppliers to directly access the inventory levels and sales information of their products at any of Checkers Hyper's more than ten thousand stores. Using Retail Link, suppliers can analyse how well their products are selling at one or more Checkers Hyper stores, with a range of reporting options. Further, Checkers Hyper requires the suppliers to use Retail Link to manage their own inventory levels. If a supplier feels that their products are selling out too quickly, they can use Retail Link to petition Checkers to raise the levels of inventory for their products. This has essentially allowed Checkers Hyper to "hire" thousands of product managers, all of whom have a vested interest in the products they are managing. This revolutionary approach to managing inventory has allowed Checkers Hyper to continue to drive prices down and respond to market forces quickly.

Today, Checkers Hyper continues to innovate with information technology. Using its tremendous market presence, any technology that Checkers Hyper requires its suppliers to implement immediately becomes a business standard.

Case study adapted from Fowler, J., Smith B., and Bourgeois, D. (2022). "Information Systems for Business and Beyond, Fanshawe College Pressbooks, London, Ontario.

Q.1.1.	Of the various types of Management Information Systems available to many organisations, write a half-page report advising on two potential information systems that could be recommended to Checker's Hyper for its operations.	(20 Marks)
Q.1.2.	Checkers Hyper discussed how the company used information technology to become South Africa's leading retailer. Checkers Hyper has continued to improve and remain a leader in the use of technology. Do some original research and write a half-page report detailing a technology that Checkers Hyper has recently implemented or is pioneering. Discuss the features of the technology, as well as its limitations and advantages.	(20 Marks)

Assignment Topic 2**(Marks: 40)**

Referring to the Case study provided in Q1, read the questions below and answer all the questions that follow.

Q.2.1.	Do some research and identify possible readings on potential technologies that Checkers Hyper could have used to address some of the issues the organisation experienced.	(20 Marks)
Q.2.2.	Write a half-a-page report detailing how 'buyer power' and 'supplier power' may have influenced Checker's Hyper's choice of competitive advantage strategy.	(20 Marks)

Assignment Topic 3**(Marks: 20)***Answer all the questions that follow.*

Q.3.1.	Of the following primary components of an information system (data, information, databases, and processes), which do you think are the most important to the success of a business organisation? Write a half-page answer to this question supporting your argument(s).	(20 Marks)

[TOTAL MARKS: 100]

Please note: Attach this rubric to your work when submitting your **Assignment**. This information needs to be included in the online submission.

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Marking Criteria	Fail	Average	Above average	Excellent
Q.1.1. Knowledge: Theoretical concepts related to types of Management Information Systems that can be recommended for business operations. [20 Marks]	- Theoretical concepts related to the types of Management Information Systems are not explained. - Concepts are presented incorrectly. - The incorrect concepts have been selected.	- Theoretical concepts related to the types of Management Information Systems are correctly explained. - Not all theoretical concepts are directly relevant. - There is an over-reliance on direct quotes.	- There is some focus on the most important concepts related to the types of Management Information Systems. - There is logic in the organisation of the concepts.	- Key points of the theory are identified and explained. - Able to paraphrase all concepts. - There is an attempt to integrate concepts.
	0 – 5 Marks	6 – 10 Marks	11– 15 Marks	16 – 20 Marks

Marking Criteria	Does not meet the required standard	Meets the required standard	Partially exceeds the required standard	Greatly exceeds the required standard
Q. 1.2 Knowledge: Theory and application regarding the use of Information Technology, its features, and limitations.	- No evidence that the information was examined from different angles; - Student did not weigh up the evidence for and against – very limited reflection.	Limited evidence of an analytical approach to the use of Information Technology, its features, and limitations.	- Evidence of an approach to demonstrate the type of Information Technology implemented or being pioneered, including its features, and limitations. - Examined the information in detail from different perspectives.	- Evidence of a concise approach to the research consulted. - Examined the information about the potential Information Technology implemented, its features, and limitations. - Weighing up the arguments and evidence for and against.
[20 Marks]	0 – 5 Marks	6 – 10 Marks	11– 15 Marks	16 – 20 Marks

Marking Criteria	Fail	Average	Above average	Excellent
Q.2.1. Knowledge: Theory and application regarding potential technologies that could be used to address some of the issues the organisation experienced. [20 Marks]	- Theoretical concepts regarding the potential technologies are not explained. - Concepts are presented incorrectly. - The incorrect concepts have been selected.	- Theoretical concepts regarding the potential technologies are correctly explained. - Not all theoretical concepts are directly relevant. - There is an over-reliance on unreferenced sources.	- There is some focus on the most important concepts. - There is logic in the organisation of the concepts related to potential technologies.	- Key points of the theory are identified and explained. - Able to paraphrase all concepts. - There is an attempt to integrate concepts.
	0 – 5 Marks	6 – 10 Marks	11– 15 Marks	16 – 20 Marks

Marking Criteria	Does not meet the required standard	Meets the required standard	Partially exceeds the required standard	Greatly exceeds the required standard
Q.2.2. Knowledge: A report detailing how the buyer and supplier powers may influence the choice of competitive advantage strategy. [20 Marks]	- Theoretical concepts relating to the buyer and supplier powers are not explained. - Concepts are presented incorrectly. - The incorrect concepts have been selected.	- Theoretical concepts related to the buyer and supplier powers are correctly explained. - Not all theoretical concepts are directly relevant. - There is an over-reliance on unreferenced sources.	- There is some focus on the most important concepts. - There is logic in the organisation of the concepts related to the buyer and supplier powers are explained.	- Key points of the theory are identified and explained. - Able to paraphrase all concepts. - There is an attempt to integrate concepts.
	0 – 5 Marks	6 – 10 Marks	11– 15 Marks	16 – 20 Marks

Marking Criteria	Does not meet the required standard	Meets the required standard	Partially exceeds the required standard	Greatly exceeds the required standard
Q. 3.1. Critical and Analytical Discussion regarding the primary components of an Information System and their importance to the success of a business organisation. [20 Marks]	- No evidence that the information was examined from different angles; - Student did not weigh up the evidence for and against – very limited reflection.	Limited evidence of an analytical approach about the importance of the components of an Information System and how these may affect the success of a business organisation.	- Evidence of an approach to demonstrate how the components of an Information System may affect the success of a business organisation. - Examined the information in detail from different perspectives.	- Evidence of a concise approach to the research consulted. - Examined the importance of information systems components and how they may affect the success of a business organisation. - Weighing up the arguments and evidence for and against.
	0 – 9 Marks	10 – 12 Marks	13 – 14 Marks	15 – 20 Marks

[TOTAL MARKS: 100]